

Excel for Accounting and Inventory Reporting

(Automate calculations and reduce errors in daily reporting)

Overview

This course uses an artifact sequence approach in which participants build a complete, formula-driven accounting and inventory workbook across five topic blocks. At the start of the session, participants import a live dataset from the web and rename it as a named Table. Each topic block then builds on that Table: extending it with calculated columns and formulas, cross-referencing records across a second table, summarizing results using dynamic array functions, and validating and protecting the completed workbook.

Objectives

Upon completion of the course, participants will be able to build a formula-driven, error-resistant Excel workbook for accounting and inventory reporting.

Specifically, participants will be able to:

- organize and extend an imported Excel Table with calculated columns and formatting
- automate recurring calculations using conditional and aggregation functions
- cross-reference records across tables using lookup functions and data validation
- summarize data dynamically using UNIQUE, FILTER, SORT, and SUMIFS
- validate and protect a completed workbook before distribution

Who Should Participate

- Assistant to Managerial-level staff who prepare or review accounting and inventory reports.
- Employees who use Excel daily for reporting and want to work more efficiently.
- Staff who rely on manual re-typing, copy-paste, or unstructured ranges for reporting.
- Anyone with basic Excel familiarity who needs reliable, formula-driven reporting skills.

Key Topics

- I. Structuring Source Data as Excel Tables
 - a. renaming and organizing worksheets and tables
 - b. adding calculated columns with table references
 - c. adding a Total Row to summarize key columns
 - d. applying formatting and print-ready layout
- II. Automating Everyday Calculations
 - a. typing SUM, AVERAGE, COUNT, and COUNTA formulas
 - b. using IF to flag stock and payment status
 - c. using SUMIFS and COUNTIFS for conditional sums
 - d. wrapping formulas in IFERROR for clean outputs
- III. Cross-Referencing Data Across Tables
 - a. matching records using VLOOKUP and XLOOKUP
 - b. converting the reference table to a plain range
 - c. dropdown lists via Data → Data Validation
 - d. sorting and filtering via Sort and AutoFilter
- IV. Summarizing Data with Dynamic Arrays
 - a. extracting distinct values using UNIQUE
 - b. building a live filtered view using FILTER
 - c. ordering dynamic arrays with SORT and SORTBY
 - d. pairing SUMIFS with UNIQUE for a summary table
- V. Validating and Finalizing the Workbook
 - a. testing by refreshing the source query dataset
 - b. auditing via Formulas → Formula Auditing tools
 - c. resolving #N/A, #REF!, #DIV/0!, #SPILL! errors
 - d. protecting the sheet via Review → Protect Sheet